

## BUILD MANUAL

# RONIN + CAT ANIMATION RIG

A shape-by-shape Figma guide for building a simple, mobile-app mascot that is ready to animate in Rive.



**Build rule: simple silhouettes first. Details come only after every moving part exists as its own named layer.**

# Tools — learn these once

You will reuse the same small set of Figma tools throughout the manual.

|                          |                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>V — Move / Select</b> | Click a shape to select it. Drag to move. Hold Shift while selecting to choose several shapes.       |
| <b>O — Ellipse</b>       | Press O, then drag. Hold Shift for a perfect circle. Use this for the head, eyes and rounded joints. |
| <b>R — Rectangle</b>     | Press R and drag. Increase Corner radius in the right panel to make torsos, feet and bags.           |
| <b>P — Pen</b>           | Press P and click around a custom silhouette. Click the first point again to close the shape.        |
| <b>⌘D — Duplicate</b>    | Duplicates the selected shape. Useful for making matching legs, arms and eyes.                       |
| <b>⌘G — Group</b>        | Select related pieces and group them. Name groups Ronin, Cat, Sword and Backpack.                    |
| <b>Rename</b>            | Double-click a layer name in the left panel. Name it immediately before drawing the next piece.      |
| <b>Opacity + Lock</b>    | Select the reference, set Opacity to 30% in the right panel, then press <b>⇧ ⌘ L</b> to lock it.     |

# Step 1 — Set up the tracing frame

Create a 600 × 600 frame. Place the Canva artwork inside, set it to 30% opacity, then lock it.

## STEP 01

### Set up the tracing frame

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#### REFERENCE

**Opacity 30%**

**Lock layer**

**Draw above it**

**Checkpoint:** The reference is locked and cannot be selected accidentally.

## Step 2 — Build the rear silhouette

Use simple shapes. Extend each leg segment beneath the joint by about 10–15 px.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.

## Step 3 — Add the back arm and backpack

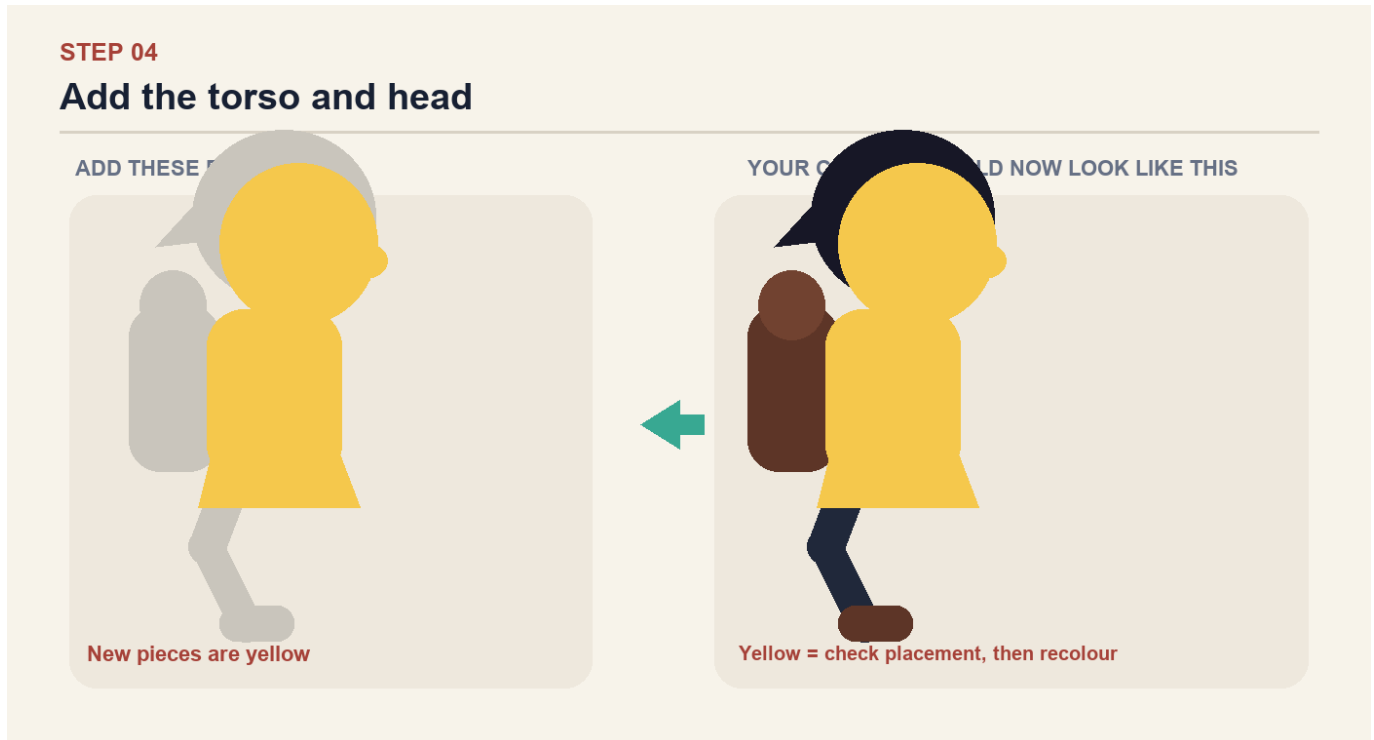
Keep the back arm behind the torso. The backpack may overlap the shoulder.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.

## Step 4 — Add the torso and head

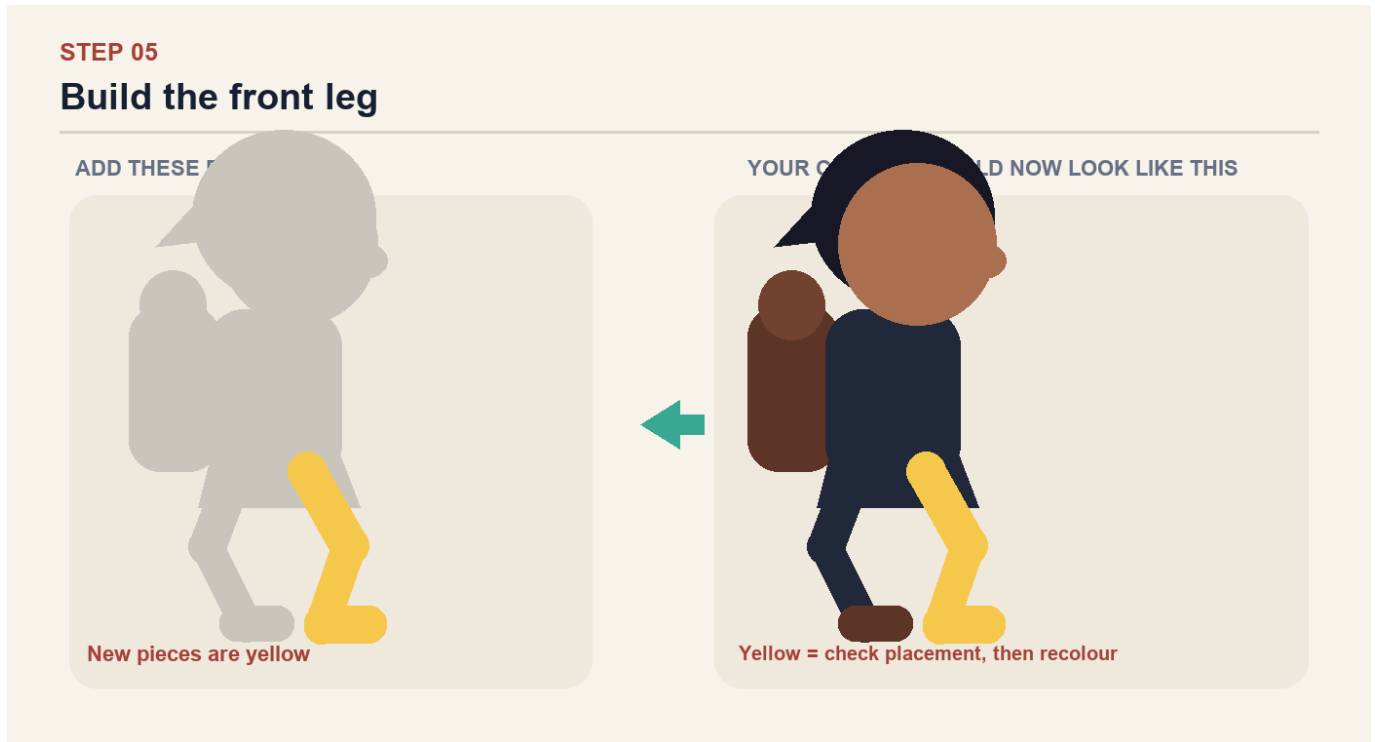
Use one rounded torso shape and one large head ellipse. Keep the head oversized and app-like.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.

# Step 5 — Build the front leg

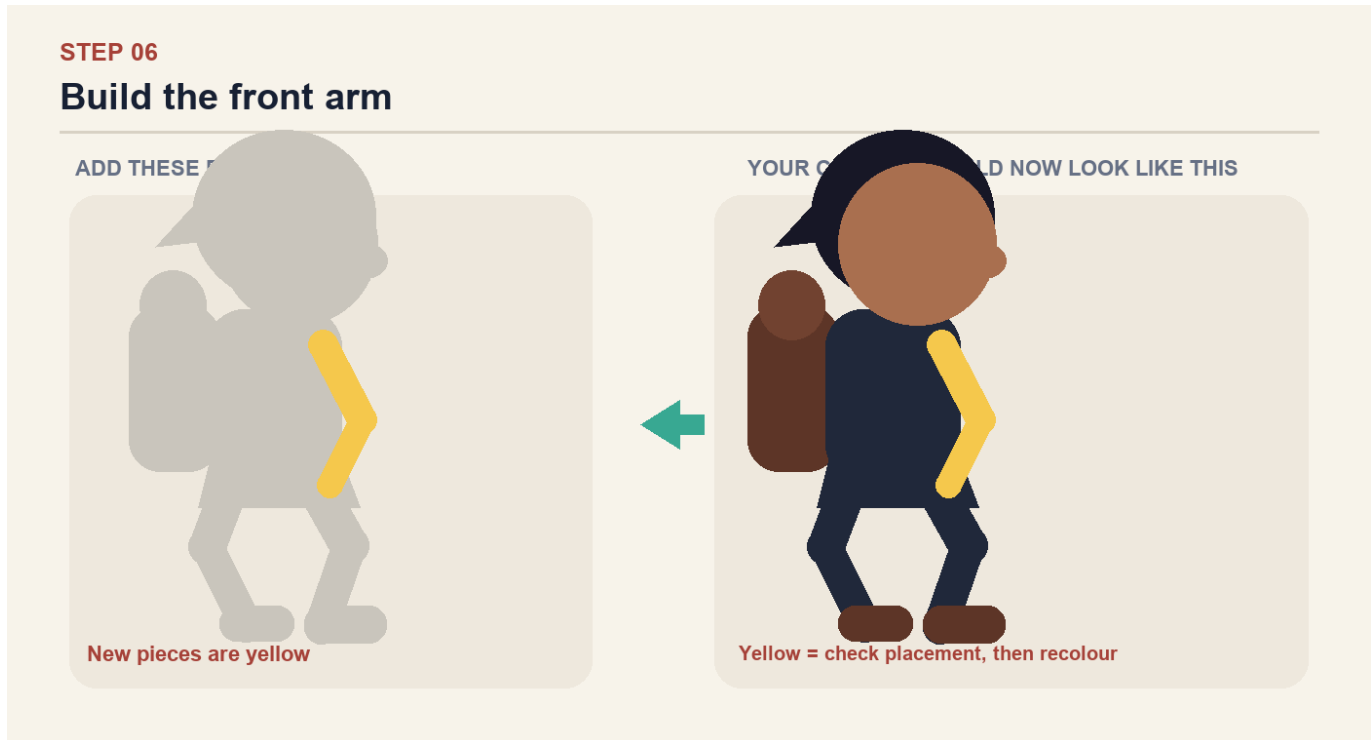
Make thigh, shin and foot separate layers. Hide the top of the thigh beneath the torso.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.

## Step 6 — Build the front arm

Make upper arm and forearm separate. Overlap them at the elbow.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.



# Step 7 — Add the character details

Use only a few bold shapes. Avoid individual hair strands, textures and realistic shading.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.

## Step 8 — Add the sword

Keep the complete sword in one group so it can move with the torso or hand.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.

## Step 9 — Build the cat silhouette

Keep the cat in its own group. Separate the tail and legs so they can move.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.

## Step 10 — Add the cat face

Use only an eye and tiny nose. Readability at phone size matters more than detail.



**Checkpoint:** Every yellow piece exists as a separate, clearly named layer. Nothing has been flattened.

# Final check — prepare for Rive

Do not export until every box below is true.

- 1 The Ronin and cat are separate top-level groups.
- 2 Upper and lower arms are separate layers.
- 3 Upper and lower legs are separate layers.
- 4 Each joint overlaps by roughly 10–15 px, so rotation cannot reveal gaps.
- 5 Back limbs sit behind the torso; front limbs sit in front.
- 6 The reference image is hidden before export.
- 7 Every layer has a useful name; no important layer is still called Vector or Rectangle.
- 8 The character remains readable when viewed at approximately 120 px tall.

## Recommended layer order

**Hair Back → Back Leg → Back Arm → Backpack → Torso → Head → Front Leg → Front Arm → Hair Front → Headband → Face → Sword**

**Cat: Tail → Back Legs → Body → Front Legs → Head → Face**

**When you reach this page, send a screenshot of your Layers panel and canvas. We can correct the structure before you begin animating.**